

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- Sheffield's finance and performance policy committee heard Monday that multi-academy trust chief executives have shown 'a real commitment' to reducing exclusions — but the council's own exclusions team is often only pulled in once a pupil has already been excluded, not before.
→ **For your school:** Worth checking whether early-intervention contact is reaching MAPs schools ahead of a managed move or exclusion, not just after.
- A quieter day otherwise — nothing new broke overnight across DfE, Ofsted, SEND or national funding beyond what's already on your radar.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

3 Oct 2026 — NEU opens a formal strike ballot over teacher pay and school funding, covering 280,000+ teachers; closes 15 Dec, with action possible from early 2027 if it passes.

Autumn 2026 — DfE response due to its EOTAS/alternative-provision SEND reform consultation, which closed 18 September.

■ SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

▪ **Council points to MAT engagement as the next step on rising exclusions.** Following Monday's committee report on the 32% rise in Sheffield exclusions, the council's strategic director for children's services said she had met multi-academy trust chief executives, who 'showed a real commitment' to keeping children in school. Cllr Douglas Johnson flagged that the council's exclusions team too often becomes involved only at the point of exclusion, rather than earlier when a placement is at risk. ([The Star](#))

→ **For your school:** Useful if you're approached about earlier support before a managed move or exclusion is finalised.

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

280,000+

Teachers eligible to vote in the NEU's formal strike ballot over pay and school funding, opening 3 October and closing 15 December.

National Education Union, Sept 2026

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

■ SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.